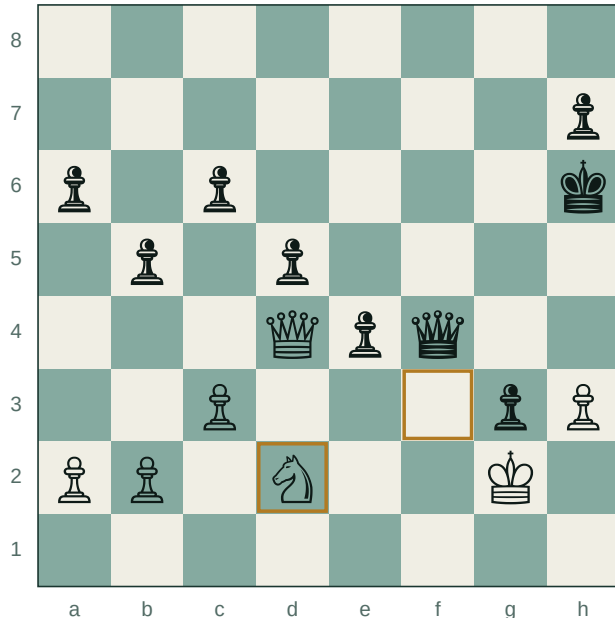


Deflection tactics: Black, move 44

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 44.Nd2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

44...c5 45. Qxc5 Qxd2+

44...c5 The pawn moves from c6 to c5. Recorded reply: **45.Qxc5**.

45...Qxd2+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the knight on d2.

At the end, nominal material is White 13 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +2:** the balance goes from +0 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g2. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.